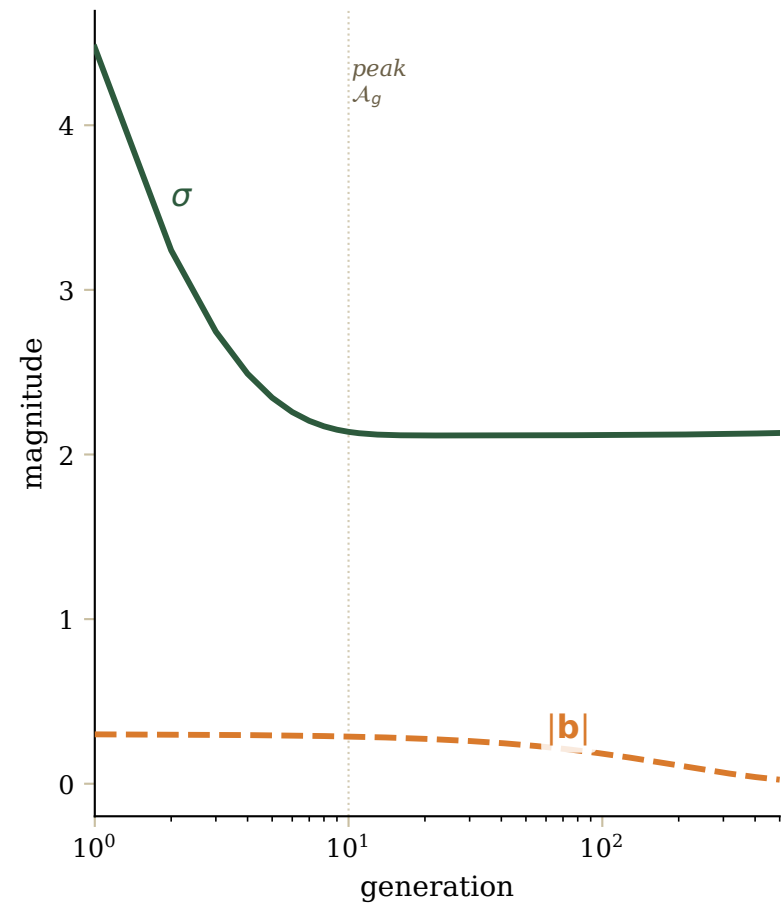
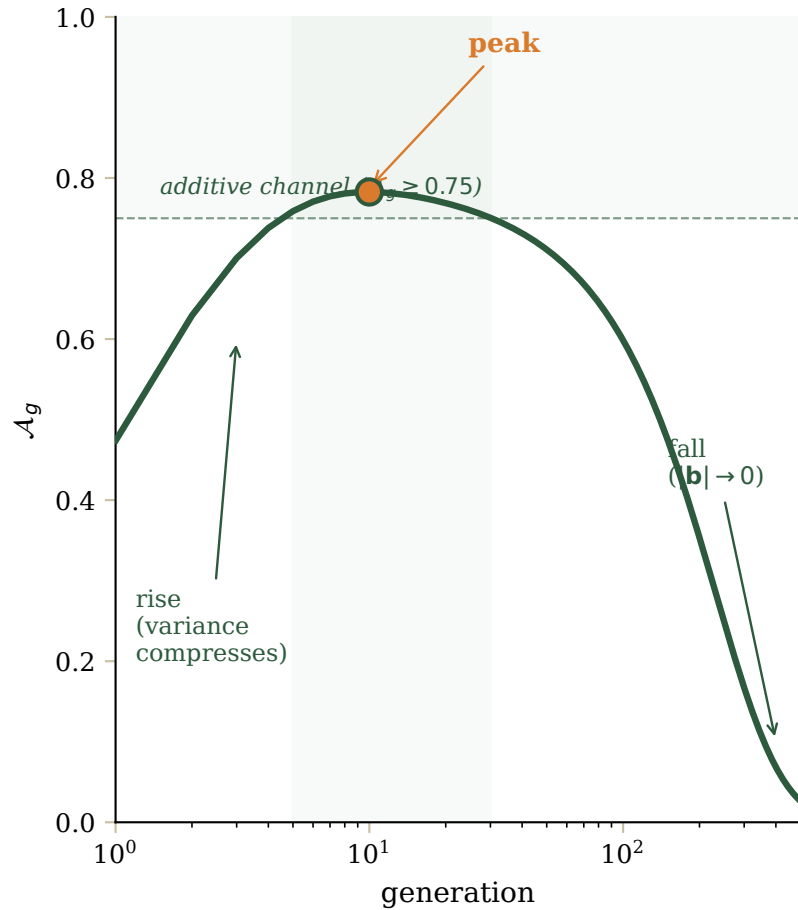


A. Variance compresses fast; gradient decays slow**B.** $\mathcal{A}_g$ rises, plateaus in the channel, then falls**C.** Phase portrait: trajectory through the $\mathcal{A}_g$ landscape